

Three days later, Liam still found himself in a foul mood. The Saturday public session was trying at the best of times, a day that Liam always was scheduled to work without fail. Screaming cars and previous parents were not a recipe for a calm mood and he could not get out of the funk that missing his skating time had caused. Sometimes he wished he had a better job, not one that alternated between flipping burgers and chasing wayward cars to spice up the day.

He slumped on the sofa, staring sulky down at the game board on the coffee table. Colourful squares and fantastical

names were not to his liking
bought and he shot a look at
his friends, crowing at their
expressions of great concentration.
More used to online roleplaying
games - not of the adult
variety - he tired of the
day. Eyelids drooping, the
other rubbed the back of his
paw over his eyes as he
yawned.

"Keeping you awake, are we?"

A young stag jiggled a pair of
dice in one paw, small rack
of antlers inclined as he observed
him critically. Bristling, the other
straightened, temper flashing.

"Oh, not at all," he said blandly.

I have been thinking about you very much lately
 and wondering how you are getting on.
 I hope you are well and happy.
 I am still here, working hard,
 but sometimes I feel like giving up.
 Life is so full of ups and downs.
 I miss our old times together.
 Please write back soon.
 Your friend,
 John Doe

Handwritten signature

I am a happy girl. I
 have many friends. I
 love to play with them.
 I am a happy girl. I
 have many friends. I
 love to play with them.

March 1941 - 10

"Your dulcet tone is more than enough to soothe me right to sleep."

The others chuckled, light hearted in the first furlong of their Saturday night. All in their early twenties, the five made an interesting collection together. Enamoured with technology and digital pursuits, there was no mistaking the group for anything other than cheerful geeks. The five sat around the lower coffee table: a badger, ~~the~~ leopard, horse, squirrel and lapwing.

Taking a sip from a glass of water emblazoned with a spaceship of some kind, Berko, the strikingly

patterned leopard, pushed his glasses further up his nose from where they had slid. Once again, he had lost the clips to keep them in place: his favourite trick. He smiled shyly at Liam.

"Neil's just grumpy because the pizza isn't here yet." He arched his head towards the young stag. ~~how~~ "He gets... how do you say it? 'Hungry'?"

"What sort of word is that?" Neil scoffed, one arm thrown across the back of his sofa. "St. It's not a word."

Berto frowned, deflated.

"But I saw it online..."

... and looking beyond something
... and some ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...

... and ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...

... and ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...
... and ...

... and ...

... and ...

"Don't believe everything you read online. That's thick."

Neil smirked, amber eyes sharp.

"Like something else."

They groaned, Liam clapping a paw to his forehead.

"Honestly, Neil, doesn't that joke ever get old?" Liam asked.

"Who says it's a joke?"

Neil grinned and dug a paw into the bowl of popcorn, tossing it up in the air. One lovely kernel landed in his mouth - the rest scattered over the sofa and floor. The badger licked his